

Next.js Deployment & Hosting Guide

Comprehensive Step-by-Step Manual for Hosting Thanniru Yaswanth's Portfolio Website

This manual provides clear instructions to host your Next.js website live on the web for **100% free** with automated SSL (HTTPS), global CDN distribution, and full support for your **OpenRouter AI Digital Twin** and **Contact Email API**.

Method 1: Deploy via Vercel + GitHub (Recommended)

Vercel is built by the creators of Next.js and offers zero-configuration hosting with automatic builds whenever you push code updates to GitHub.

Step 1: Push Project Code to GitHub

Open PowerShell in your site directory (c:\Users\batma\Desktop\VibeCode\Site) and execute:

```
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit of Next.js portfolio website"
git branch -M main
```

Create a new public/private repository on [GitHub.com](https://github.com) named **yaswanth-portfolio** and push your code:

```
git remote add origin https://github.com/Thanniru-yaswanth03/yaswanth-portfolio.git
git push -u origin main
```

Step 2: Connect & Deploy on Vercel

1. Navigate to **vercel.com** and sign in using your GitHub account.
2. Click **Add New...** → **Project**.
3. Select your **yaswanth-portfolio** repository and click **Import**.
4. Expand **Environment Variables** and configure:
 - **NAME:** OPENROUTER_API_KEY
 - **VALUE:** 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
5. Click **Deploy**.

Method 2: Direct Command Line Deploy (npx vercel)

Deploy directly from your terminal without requiring GitHub first:

```
npx vercel
```

Follow the brief browser prompt, add OPENROUTER_API_KEY in your Vercel project dashboard, then execute `npx vercel --prod`.

Post-Deployment Verification Checklist

1. **AI Digital Twin:** Test the floating chat drawer on your live site to confirm OpenRouter responses work.
2. **Email Contact Form:** Test submitting a message on the contact section to verify emails land in

yash1th2k4@gmail.com.

3. **Custom Domain (Optional):** Link your custom domain (e.g. *thanniruyaswanth.com*) under Vercel Settings → Domains.